

Stevens Motion System

A functional motion framework for the Stevens AI butler app grounded in calm refinement and sharp efficiency, with moments of warmth and delight choreographed intentionally throughout.

- Calm & Refined
- Sharp & Efficient
- Graceful with flair
- Delight & trust

01 Principles

01

Composed

Stevens never rushes, never fidgets. Every motion is intentional, like a butler who moves with purpose across a room.

Calm & Refined

02

Precise

Efficiency is elegance. Transitions get out of the way quickly so users stay in their flow no lingering, no lag.

Sharp · Efficient

03

Warmly flair

Small, choreographed moments of delight i.e.just enough to notice. Reserve flair for milestones and responses, not every tap.

Delight · Warmth

02 Curves

Stevens uses four motion curves. Each maps to a specific type of action choose by behaviour, not aesthetics

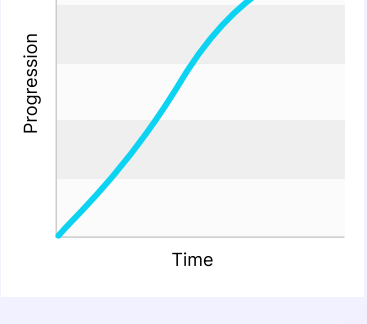
Settle-In

Entry

Cubic-bezier (0.33, 0.27, 0.6, 1.0)

Elements entering the screen. Arrives with quiet confidence quick in, smooth cushioned landing.
Eg : bottom sheets, cards, modals, and chat bubbles appearing.

Duration 200–450ms Small component 200–300ms Large / full-screen 350–450ms



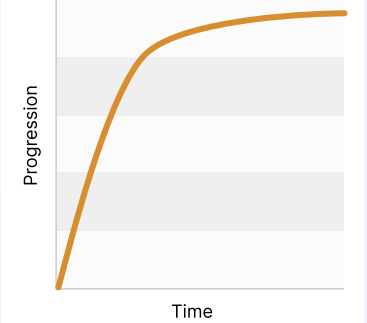
Depart

Exit

cubic-bezier (0.2, 1.0, 0.3, 1.0)

Elements leaving the screen. Quick, decisive like a butler retreating cleanly after completing a task. Returns control to the user immediately.

Duration 100–300ms Small component 100 – 200ms Large panel 200–300ms



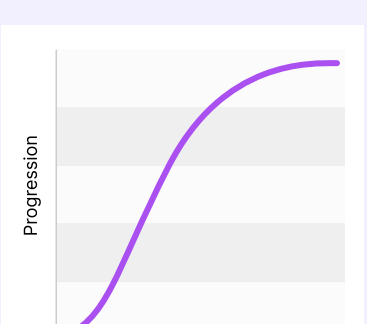
Poise Flair

Flair

cubic-bezier (0.34, 0.00, 0.20, 0.99)

In-screen movement, onboarding, tab transitions, and moments of intentional delight. Smooth entering and landing both the signature curve of Stevens' personality.

Duration 300–500ms Beautification / onboarding 400–500ms Tab / in-screen move 300–380ms



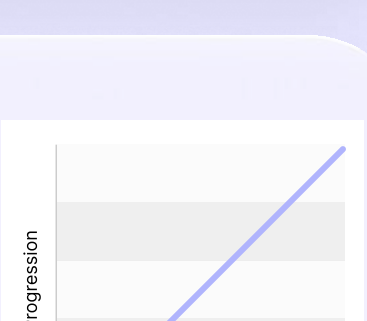
Instant

Linear

linear (0, 0, 1, 1) - No easing

Opacity changes, colour shifts, button feedback. No spatial movement involved, so easing adds no value. Keep it invisible the fastest feedback possible.

Duration 80–150ms Use for Opacity, colour, taps



03 Duration

100–500ms is the full range. Exit faster than you enter. Never animate shorter than 80ms (imperceptible) or longer than 500ms (feels broken).

Tier	Range	Use for	Curve
T1 Fast	80 - 250ms	Button taps, toggles, checkboxes, exit sequences, opacity	Depart · Instant
T2 Standard	200 – 400ms	Bottom sheets, modals, card enters, chat message appears, tab switch	Settle-In · Poise
T3 Expressive	350–500ms	Onboarding, task completion moments, in-screen rearrangement	Poise

Quick Reference

Modal / Card enters

cubic-bezier (0.33, 0.27, 0.6, 1.0)

Settle-In 350–420ms

Modal / card exits

cubic-bezier (0.2, 1.0, 0.3, 1.0)

Depart 200–250ms

Chat bubble

cubic-bezier (0.33, 0.27, 0.6, 1.0)

Settle-In 260–300ms

Task complete / milestone

cubic-bezier (0.34, 0.00, 0.20, 0.99)

Poise 420–480ms

Tab / in-screen nav

cubic-bezier (0.34, 0.00, 0.20, 0.99)

Poise 300–360ms

Button tap / toggle

linear (0, 0, 1, 1)

Instant 80–120ms

Opacity / colour shift

linear (0, 0, 1, 1)

Instant 80–150ms

Onboarding screens

cubic-bezier (0.34, 0.00, 0.20, 0.99)

Poise 450–500ms

04 Choreography

Stevens is a butler. He presents things in the right order, with the right emphasis. When multiple elements animate together, sequence them intentionally.

Stagger entries

When a list or card grid enters, delay each item by 40–60ms. Lead with the most important. Never animate everything at once.

Exit before enter

When replacing content, the outgoing element exits first (Depart, 150ms), then the incoming element settles in. Never overlap both at full opacity.

Delight is earned

Poise curve and T3 durations are reserved for milestone moments like task complete, first response, onboarding. Everyday taps stay T1.

One focal point

One animated element leads. Supporting elements have less travel distance and subtler easing. Never compete for attention.

05 Context-specific rules

Stevens lives in three primary mobile contexts. Each has its own motion character.

Conversational chat

- New message bubble: Settle-In, 280ms, slight Y offset (12px up)
- Typing indicator: Poise, looping 800ms, subtle scale pulse
- Message send: Instant opacity 0 → 1, 120ms
- Scroll to new message: ease-out, 300ms

Cards & dashboards

- Card enter: Settle-In, 350ms, stagger 50ms per card
- Card expand: Poise, 400ms, scale from 0.96 → 1
- Card dismiss: Depart, 200ms, slide out + fade
- Data refresh: Instant opacity flicker, 100ms

Bottom sheets & modals

- Sheet enter: Settle-In from bottom Y+40, 380ms the longest enter in the system, it's a large surface
- Sheet dismiss: Depart downward, 250ms, user dismisses, hand control back fast
- Backdrop: Instant opacity 0 → 0.5, 180ms; never animate alongside the sheet
- Content inside sheet staggers in 60ms after the sheet itself lands

06 Do and Donts

✓ Do

- Use Poise for the chat response animation when Stevens first speaks. it's a small earned moment of warmth.
- Keep exits under 250ms so the user feels in control.
- Stagger list items when 3 or more appear together.
- Use T1 Instant for all haptic-adjacent feedback (taps, toggles).

✗ Don't

- Don't animate every interaction with Poise, it's a signal, not a default.
- Don't let entering and exiting elements animate simultaneously at full opacity.
- Don't use durations above 500ms anywhere it reads as a loading delay.
- Don't bounce or spring Stevens is composed, not bouncy.